Reformer Assessment Class

45 minutes · main points only

WHAT TO SAY · HOW TO SET UP · WHAT TO FOCUS ON · THE GENERAL MOVEMENT
SPRINGS: RR → R – ONE SPRING CHANGE (7:30), ONE BAR CHANGE (31:30).
NOTHING ELSE MOVES.

0:00 INTRO & SCREENING RR · BAR UP

- **Say:** name, 45 min full-body reformer; front = footbar end, back = shoulder blocks; forest side / window side.
- **Ask:** new to reformer? pregnant? injuries (back, shoulder, wrist, knee, ankle)?
- **Admin:** grab a ball, consent token for hands-on, springs **two reds, bar up**.
- **Close with:** one shared breath – inhale wide into the ribs, exhale everything out.

2:00 WARM-UP RR · BAR UP · BALL IN HANDS

Ball in the hands = arms off the frame, trunk stabilises itself. Foot position descends: V → toes → balls → one leg → heels.

EXERCISE	SET-UP	FOCUS	MOVEMENT
Leg Press, Pilates V 8 + 8 pulses	Toes on bar, heels together toes apart, ball over chest	Knees over middle toes, heels stay touching; shoulders heavy	Exhale press out, inhale bend in; pulses in the **top half** only
Leg Press, toes parallel 8 + 8	Hip-width, heels lifted high	Heels don't drop coming home	Same press; pulse in upper half
Heel Raises 6 + 6 pulses	Legs straight, knees soft	Only the ankle moves; even through big toe / little toe	Inhale heels under bar, exhale lift high
Prances 20	Legs long	Fluid not bouncy; pause when both legs are long	Bend one knee, drop that heel, lift both
Double Leg Press, balls of feet 8	Parallel, hip-width	The way back is the work – 3 counts out, 3 home	Press out + ball to ceiling, in + ball to chest
Single Leg Extension + ball thread 6 e/s	One foot stays, other leg tabletop, find **neutral**	Pelvis stays level, tabletop hip doesn't grip; ribs soft	Press out + thread ball under the thigh; option 2 = extend the leg over the bar
Glute Bridge 3 articulating + 8	Heels on bar, ball between knees, arms long	Tuck/arch/settle to find neutral; carriage stays parked (hamstrings)	Peel bone by bone, ribs down at the top, squeeze ball on the way down
Glute Bridge 2 6 + pulses + hold	Stay high, keep squeeze	Hips level – only the legs move; knees over middle toes	Press out (hips lower an inch), pull in (hips lift); then pulses + 10% lower/lift
Roll Up 4	Ball down, legs long and flexed over bar	Nod first then peel; heels heavy; carriage parked	Curl up and over the legs, roll down bone by bone – last one **stays seated**

> ⚙ **SPRING CHANGE – THE ONLY ONE:** stay seated, take **ONE RED OFF**, bar stays up. Then lie back, short loops in hands.

7:30 SECTION 1 · CORE, HANDS IN STRAPS R · BAR UP

*Arms first, then arms + spine, then legs. Regress with **range and head down**, not spring.*

- **Arm Press Down** ×8 – head **down**, arms above shoulders, press long to the hips, resist back up. Ribs heavy, stop above the shoulders.
- **Abdominal Curl** ×8 – *same press, curl added on top*. Arms stay long, no elbow bend. Lift from abs not neck, space chin to chest.
- **Curl + single → double leg extension** 6 e/s + 6 – curl and stay up. Only the leg travels, the bent knee stays home (hip flexor tell).
- **Set 1** *(one long set – say so)* – extend **over** the bar ×4 → **under** the bar ×4 (only if spine stays neutral) → hold → legs only ×4 → **scissors**, full range. Watch the low back arching; send them back over the bar by name.
- **Set 2** – same start, hold, **tricep press** ×6 (upper arms still, elbows to the footbar) → hold → **flutter kick** ×20 (small, quick, from the hips).
- **The Hundred** – straight in, no rest. 5 beats in, 5 out; count the tens. **Say the breath principle out loud – it's assessed.**

> Then: roll up, step off, **NO SPRING OR BAR CHANGE** – say it out loud. Pre-cue: four leg exercises, one side only, bring the ball.

14:30 SECTION 2A · LEGS, FIRST SIDE R · BAR UP · BALL IN HANDS

Loudest block. One red = looser carriage = more balance work. Regress with range or ball down + hands on bar.

- **Long Lunge + ball pass** – front foot on floor behind the bar, back foot on shoulder block. **Demo the pass.** Diagonal line head to back heel, hip bones square, knee over middle toes. 8 plain → 8 with ball overhead (ribs down) → 6 lunge-pass-return → 8 passes held low.
- **Scooter** – standing foot on floor, other on shoulder rest, ball at chest. **Weight back in the standing heel**, knee stacked and pressing to the little toe; felt in the side glute. 8 + 8 with heel raise + 8 heel-only in the hold. *Best hands-on of the class: a hand on each hip, "hip bones square."*
- **Flying Lunge, knee tuck** ×10 – **demo this fully.** Ball down, hands on bar. Push away, sweep the leg long (one-leg plank), then knee in and long again – core brings the carriage in, not momentum.
- **Flying Lunge, knee L/R/centre** ×6 cycles – hips stay square as the knee travels.

20:00 SECTION 3 · PLANK FAMILY R · BAR UP · BALL BETWEEN KNEES

Offer the wrist option first: fists, or forearms for the plank. Ball squeeze = legs as one line.

- **Down Stretch** ×8 – half plank, knees down, hips forward of the knees. Movement from the **shoulders only**; open the chest as the carriage comes in.
- **Long Stretch** ×6 – straight out of Down Stretch, no reset. Lift the knees into high plank, shoulders over wrists, crown of the head pulling forward. Two silent breaths first. No dipping, no piking. Knees down is a real option.
- **Push-up** 3 breaths + 8 – hands wider, chest over the bar. Optional full plank hold (3 breaths, silent). Elbows wide on a diagonal, carriage stays still, chest lowers between the hands.
- **Elephant** ×8 – ball down, stand on carriage, **spine rounded**, heels down if they go. Tiny range, from the hip joint, upper body still.
- **One-Leg Elephant** 5 e/s – **spine neutral**, one leg long behind. Nothing moves above the hips; both shoulders square and level.

26:00 SECTION 2B · LEGS, SECOND SIDE YOUR OBSERVATION BLOCK

- Same four exercises. **Cut set-up cueing in half, walk and watch.**
- Mark the music change. Count only the last three. Two hands-on pelvis checks, by name.

> ⚙ **BAR CHANGE:** footbar **DOWN**, spring stays one red – after this nothing moves again.

31:30 SECTION 4 · BACK CHAIN & ARMS R · BAR DOWN · HIGH KNEELING

Set the whole room up before a single row:

- Kneel facing the straps, knees behind shoulder rests, **hips over knees** (not sitting back).
- **Ball high between the thighs** – that's what squares the pelvis for the whole block.
- **Sit closer to the straps than you think** – one red is heavy for arms.
- **Cross the ropes, not the hands** (demo it – crossed hands is the common error), hold down at the silver knots.

EXERCISE	FOCUS	MOVEMENT
Low / narrow Row ×10	Middle of the back; control **both** directions – "contract and resist", not release; no rib flare	Elbows back, hands to waist, blades together without pinching
High / wide Row ×10	Higher, into the upper back; open collarbones – elbows back, not up	Elbows to just below shoulder height, wide and back
Single-Arm Row + rotation 8 e/s	**Hips face forward, ribs turn** – that's what the ball is for; mid-back, no momentum	Row the elbow back, let the body follow; their choice of high or low

Then uncross the ropes, stay high kneeling, ball stays.

- *Optional* **Shoulder Retractions** ×8 – arms by the hips, palms forward, blades to the midline, no shrugging.
- *Optional* **Reverse Fly → V** ×8 – arms to shoulder height, draw back in line with the shoulders, ribs hug in; V layer = palms down, lift from the back.
- **Bicep Curl → hold → Press Up** 10 + hold + 6 – elbows lifted just below the shoulders, little fingers to the eyeline. Hold (2 breaths), then press overhead – **ribs stay down, shoulders away from the ears.**
- *Optional* **Mountain Climber** ×10 – only if on time. Hands on the frame, feet on carriage, shoulders over wrists, hips low, knees in from the deep abs.

> **BUFFER:** behind? drop these three optionals first – never cut the second leg side or the cooldown.

39:30 COOLDOWN R · BAR DOWN

Drop your voice. Music down. Static holds, 5–8 breaths, minimal cueing. Sequence descends seated → kneeling → supine.

- **Mermaid** – sit sideways, reach up and over, lengthen the ribs apart, don't collapse.
- **Hip opener → quad stretch** – facing the footbar, back knee down. **Tuck the tailbone first**, then sink – otherwise it's just an arched back. Optional: catch the back foot.
- **Supine Figure 4** – ankle over opposite thigh, draw the thigh in, exhale to soften.
- **Final twist** – knees together, arms wide, knees fall side to side, shoulders stay heavy.
- **Final breath** – hands on ribs, same breath as the start. **20 full seconds of silence.**

44:00 OUTRO

- Roll to the side and sit. Acknowledge the work. Questions welcome.
- Housekeeping: springs back on, wipe the equipment.
- **Stand by the door and close the screening loop by name** – "how was the knee today?" – it's what earns the screening marks.